

Friday, 10 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 23°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 35° 21°	MANCHESTER Overcast 34° 19°	GLASGOW Overcast 28° 17°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-----------------------------------	--------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The minister leading a major review into disability benefits has admitted the current system isn't fit for purpose.

Sir Stephen Timms says Personal Independence Payments, or PIP, in England and Wales need changing. It's a key benefit for millions of people with long-term health conditions.

TOPIC · UK
- 2

Nigel Farage's by-election in Clacton has been officially confirmed, with the vote likely to happen in mid-August.

Reform UK MP Lee Anderson formally moved the writ in the Commons. Mr Farage resigned his seat yesterday to trigger the contest, which he will stand in.

TOPIC · UK
- 3

A major blaze has wrecked a historic building on Edinburgh's Princes Street, with firefighters battling the flames through the night.

The fire broke out in the early hours at the old Debenhams store. Emergency services are still on the scene, with significant damage reported.

TOPIC · UK
- 4

The leader of the Restore Britain party has caused controversy after describing the Dunblane tragedy as 'one murder'.

Rupert Lowe criticised the ban on handguns in the UK, linking it directly to the 1996 school shooting. His comments have drawn widespread condemnation.

TOPIC · UK
- 5

Some of Britain's biggest research labs are facing cuts, despite the government announcing record levels of science funding.

There are concerns that while overall spending is up, specific institutions are struggling. This could impact vital research and development across the country.

TOPIC · UK

What's coming up

1 Justin Bieber is set to join Madonna, Shakira and BTS for the spectacular FIFA World Cup final half-time show.

This Super Bowl-style performance marks Bieber's latest big comeback, following his appearances at Coachella. It promises to be a global musical event.

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see perform at the World Cup final?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 Pontypridd, Birkenhead and the Isle of Bute are among the shortlisted locations for the first ever UK Town of Culture award.

Basildon, Grimsby and Rotherham also made the 15-strong list, alongside Strabane. The initiative aims to celebrate cultural vibrancy in towns across the nation.

ON AIR – Which town do you think deserves to be crowned the first UK Town of Culture?

CULTURE · COMING UP

3 Spider-Man star Tom Holland has spoken about his 'real pinch-me moment' working on Christopher Nolan's highly anticipated movie, The Odyssey.

Holland and other cast members have been sharing insights into the making of the film. It's one of the most talked-about upcoming releases.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Tom Holland in a Christopher Nolan film?

FILM · COMING UP

4 The Pitt and Hacks are leading the nominations for America's most prestigious TV awards, the Emmys.

The full list of nominations has been revealed, setting the stage for a competitive night. However, hit show Stranger Things was notably snubbed in the top categories.

ON AIR – Which show do you think deserves to win big at the Emmys this year?

TV · COMING UP

5 K-pop superstars BTS are back in London for their first UK show since 2019, claiming they're a good luck charm for the England football team.

The pop group returned to the capital for a much-anticipated performance. Their fans, known as the ARMY, packed out the venue.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of BTS? Have you ever seen them live?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Karolina Muchova has reached the Wimbledon final after an epic tie-break victory over Coco Gauff in a thrilling semi-final.**

Muchova recovered from match point down to win the deciding-set tie-break on Centre Court. It was a truly dramatic encounter that had fans on the edge of their seats.

ON AIR – What a match! Have you ever seen a comeback quite like that at Wimbledon?

TENNIS · UK

2 **British wildcard Arthur Fery has made Wimbledon history by storming past Flavio Cobolli to reach a shock semi-final.**

Fery defeated the Italian in straight sets, becoming only the second wildcard in the tournament's history to reach the last four. It's an incredible run for the young Brit.

ON AIR – What an amazing story! Are you rooting for Arthur Fery to go all the way?

TENNIS · UK

3 **Alan Shearer has admitted he's changed his mind and now believes England can actually win the World Cup.**

The former England striker explained his newfound confidence after the team's performances. He thinks they can go further than he initially thought.

ON AIR – Do you share Alan Shearer's new belief? Can England win the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Rory McIlroy has set the pace at the Scottish Open, revelling in his return to links golf with a superb five-under 65.**

McIlroy's impressive first round puts him in a strong position early in the tournament. He looks comfortable back on the challenging Scottish course.

ON AIR – Are you following the Scottish Open this weekend? Who are you backing to win?

GOLF · UK

5 **Brentford have signed former England striker Callum Wilson on a 12-month contract after his exit from relegated West Ham.**

Wilson joins the Bees as they look to strengthen their squad for the upcoming season. It's a significant move for the experienced forward.

ON AIR – Do you think Callum Wilson is a good signing for Brentford?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful trend for 'miniature garden fences' is making suburban streets feel a little more charming.**
Homeowners are adding tiny decorative fences around flowerbeds and small front garden features, bringing a whimsical, dollhouse-like quality to their properties. It's a lovely way to add a personal touch and a smile to passers-by.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'polishing shoes' is being rediscovered as a mindful daily ritual.**
Instead of being a chore, many are finding the act of cleaning and shining footwear to be a calming and satisfying start or end to their day. It's a small return to traditional craftsmanship and taking pride in one's belongings.
- 3 A new study suggests that 'watching squirrels' in your garden can significantly boost your mood.**
Their playful antics and energetic scurrying provide a dose of nature's entertainment, proving to be a surprisingly effective stress-buster. Grab a cuppa and enjoy the free show!
- 4 The nostalgic appeal of 'collecting old postcards' is seeing a gentle resurgence among hobbyists.**
People are enjoying the thrill of finding vintage cards, often with handwritten messages from decades ago, offering a fascinating glimpse into social history and travel from yesteryear.
- 5 Interest in 'identifying cloud formations' is encouraging more people to look up and appreciate the sky.**
Learning about different types of clouds, from fluffy cumulus to wispy cirrus, is turning everyday sky-gazing into an engaging and educational pastime. It's a wonderful way to connect with the natural world above us.
- 6 The humble 'clothes peg' is being hailed as a surprisingly versatile household item beyond the washing line.**
From sealing snack bags to holding craft projects or even creating makeshift photo displays, people are finding countless ingenious uses for these simple wooden or plastic clips around the home.
- 7 A charming trend for 'leaving small painted stones' in public places for others to find is brightening up communities.**
Often decorated with positive messages or colourful designs, these 'kindness rocks' bring unexpected moments of joy and connection, encouraging a treasure hunt spirit in local parks and pathways.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'naming' what item of furniture in their house, even if they'd never tell anyone?

ANSWER: THEIR FAVOURITE ARMCHAIR OR SOFA. APPARENTLY, IT'S OFTEN GIVEN A GRAND OR AFFECTIONATE TITLE!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'food combination' that they absolutely love, but others might find a bit odd?

ANSWER: THINGS LIKE CRISPS IN A SANDWICH, OR DIPPING SPECIFIC BISCUITS INTO CERTAIN DRINKS. IT'S ALL ABOUT PERSONAL PREFERENCE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old board game' from your childhood, and it's surprisingly fun to play again?

What's a classic game from your past that you've recently dug out and enjoyed, and why do you think it still holds its magic?

- We all have those 'little quirks' when it comes to how we organise our kitchen cupboards – perhaps a specific shelf for mugs or a very particular way the tins face?

What's one of your unique and perhaps slightly obsessive ways of arranging things in your kitchen that others might find amusing?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that despite their name, red pandas are not closely related to giant pandas? They are actually the only living members of their own unique family, Ailuridae.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the collective noun for a group of badgers is a 'stripe'? They often move in a distinctive striped formation across fields at dusk.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest fish, *Paedocypris progenetica*, is so tiny it can fit on the head of a pin.
- Bumblebees have 'fur' that helps them carry an electrostatic charge, which attracts pollen to their bodies.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Nicéphore Niépce.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', likely due to their wise and serious appearance.
- There are more than 10,000 different varieties of tomatoes worldwide.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland, standing at 1,345 metres (4,413 feet) above sea level.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The world's largest living organism is a fungus, *Armillaria ostoyae*, which covers over 2,200 acres in Oregon, USA.

On this day

Day 191 of the year, 174 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Mauritania); Christian feast day: Amalberga of Maubeuge; Christian feast day: Canute IV of Denmark; Christian feast day: Martyrs of Damascus. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Chiwetel Ejiofor, English actor
- 1949 — Greg Kihn, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2024)
- 1976 — Elijah Blue Allman, American singer and guitarist
- 1972 — Sofía Vergara, Colombian-American actress and producer
- 1942 — Ronnie James Dio, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2010)
- 1967 — Rebekah Del Rio, American singer-songwriter (died 2025)
- 1943 — Jerry Miller, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2024)
- 2001 — Isabela Merced, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Erden Eruç begins the first solo human-powered circumnavigation of the world.
- 1991 — A Beechcraft Model 99 crashes near Birmingham Municipal Airport (now Birmingham-Shuttlesworth International Airport) in Birmingham, Alabama, killing 13 of the 15 people on board.
- 1997 — Miguel Ángel Blanco, a member of Partido Popular (Spain), is kidnapped (and later murdered) in the Basque city of Ermua by ETA members, sparking widespread protests.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1951 — Korean War: Armistice negotiations begin at Kaesong.
- 420 — Having usurped the throne of Emperor Gong of Jin, Liu Yu proclaims himself Emperor of the Liu Song dynasty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2002 — The Massacre of the Innocents, a painting by Peter Paul Rubens, is sold at a Sotheby's auction for £49.5 million (US\$76.2 million) to Lord Thomson.

-

1999 — In women's association football, the United States defeats China in a penalty shoot-out at the Rose Bowl near Los Angeles to win the final match of the 1999 FIFA Women's World Cup. Watched by 90,185 spectators, the final sets a new world record for attendance at a women's spor...

- 2011 — Amid widespread backlash to revelations of phone hacking, the British weekly tabloid newspaper News of the World publishes its final issue and shuts down after nearly 168 years in print.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 192 of the year, 173 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Benedict of Nursia; Christian Feast Day: Drostan; Christian Feast Day: Kjeld; Christian Feast Day: Marciana of Toledo. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1932 — Alex Hassilev, French-born American folk singer and musician (died 2024)
- 1956 — Sela Ward, American actress
- 1952 — Stephen Lang, American actor and playwright
- 1994 — Nina Nesbitt, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1970 — Justin Chambers, American actor
- 1966 — Ricky Warwick, Northern Irish musician
- 1963 — Dean Richards, English rugby player and coach
- 1960 — Caroline Quentin, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — France legislates for the independence of Dahomey (later Benin), Upper Volta (later Burkina Faso) and Niger.
- 1962 — Project Apollo: At a press conference, NASA announces lunar orbit rendezvous as the means to land astronauts on the Moon, and return them to Earth.
- 1950 — Pakistan joins the International Monetary Fund and the International Bank.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Yugoslav Wars: Srebrenica massacre begins, lasting until 22 July.
- 1962 — First transatlantic satellite television transmission.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)